

Decision Point

P4 · When a Value Stream Conference is needed — measured instead of scheduled

What is it?

The workshop put it plainly: „Trigger it when there are significant cross-value-stream dependencies; skip it when there aren't.“ That was exactly what could not be measured — so the calendar decided instead. The decision point measures the pressure on the SEAMS between a portfolio's value streams and asks the question once the agreed threshold is reached: „Convene a Value Stream Conference?“

How it is computed

Over all open dependencies whose target belongs to ANOTHER solution of the same portfolio: status weight (blocked 3, at_risk 2, on_track 1) times overdue factor (on time 1, overdue 2, beyond 30 days 3). Whole numbers — a human can recompute the value by hand. Which ART belongs to which solution is derived from the configuration, never asserted in the register.

How to use it

```
python -m portfolio portfolio.json --cross-vs-threshold 10 --output report.html
```

Or in the GUI: the field „VSC threshold“ next to the mode selection; stored in the configuration as `report.cross_vs_threshold`. The block sits in the report and the PDF, below the dependency heatmap.

Three rules keep the alarm quiet

- External never wakes anyone: a vendor dependency is real pressure — but no conference of THESE value streams can decide about it. Reported separately, excluded from the indicator
- No agreed threshold, no alarm: the tool invents no value; an unusable entry counts as „not agreed“, not as an alarm
- Below threshold is stated out loud, not omitted — an indicator that appears only when things are bad teaches readers to read absence as „not computed“

Guardrails

The threshold belongs into the ritual, not into a default — the tool computes, the staff decides. The block deliberately does NOT appear in the conference pre-read: that is the material for a conference already convened. And a single solution has no seam between value streams — there the block says so instead of showing a reassuring zero.